



6 Key Components for Reducing ESI

1. Leadership Oversight

- Review and communicate policy statement to include assurance of safety for all by using ESI as a last resort and a commitment to the reduction of ESI
- Develop, analyze, and communicate data on [Goals to Reduce ESI](#)
- Implement, monitor, and communicate Treatment Integrity Forms
 - [Teacher Treatment Integrity Form](#)
 - [Direct Care Staff Treatment Integrity Form](#)
 - [Trauma-Informed Care practices](#)
- Prevention plan on Analysis of Debriefing Form includes performance development training as needed
 - Include families in performance development training as indicated in IEP
- Develop, communicate, and monitor [Staff Recognition Plan](#)
- Monitor the completion of the [Debriefing Form](#)
- Facilitate the [Analysis of Debriefing Form](#) and monitor implementation of the changes to future procedures
- Implement, communicate, and monitor [Oversight Plan](#)
- Develop, monitor, and communicate [Action Plan](#) for reducing ESI

2. Use Data to Inform Practice

- Gather baseline of goal to reduce ESI
- [Track, graph, analyze](#), post, and [recognize](#) the progress of the goals

3. Performance Development

- Organize a Performance Development Team to provide new hire and ongoing training (ie: monthly)
- Allow staff input on performance development training
- New Hire and Ongoing Training Includes:
 - [Behavior Skills Training](#) (BST) to guide direct care staff
 - [Debriefing](#) procedures
 - [ESI laws and regulations](#)
 - ESI [Oversight Plan](#)
 - ESI Prevention Supports (see below)
 - ESI Treatment Integrity Forms (see above)
 - [Neurobiological effects of trauma and student diagnoses](#)
 - Restraint and seclusion procedures (ie: [CPI](#))
 - [Staff Recognition Plan](#) for ESI Reduction

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4. Use ESI Prevention Supports

- Behavioral Supports:
 - [5:1 Ratio](#) of positive to negative staff to student interaction
 - [Behavior momentum](#)
 - [Choice-Making](#) strategies
 - [Comfort or Calming Area](#)
 - [Debrief](#) after each crisis incident
 - [De-escalation model](#) and strategies
 - [Extinction](#) for off-task behaviors
 - [Modification](#) of [antecedent interventions](#)
 - [Pairing](#)
 - [Pre-corrections](#)
 - [Safety plan](#) for trauma triggers
 - [Schedule of reinforcement](#)
 - [Staff self-care](#) and self-regulation strategies
- Instructional Supports:
 - Active [student engagement](#)
 - [Active supervision](#)
 - Embed Social Emotional Learning throughout the day
 - [Errorless teaching](#) procedures (you will need to create a log in on Moodle)
 - Evidence-based [academic](#), [social](#), recreational, and [transition](#) activities
 - Fast-paced instruction with little down time ([9 Effective Teaching Procedures](#))
 - Intersperse easy and difficult demands at 80/20 ratio
 - Mix and vary type and presentation of instruction tasks and demands
 - [Prompting procedures](#)
 - [Opportunities to respond](#)
 - Teach skills to fluency not just mastery
 - Train staff on academic and behavioral interventions using BST model
- Environmental Supports:
 - Class and student [schedules](#)
 - Established and defined [rules & routines](#)
 - [Organization](#) of instructional materials (includes providing materials to support staff prior to lesson starting)
 - Physical and visual [structure](#) of the classroom
 - [Transition cue](#) between activities

5. Student and Family Engagement

- Provide [choice-making](#) opportunities throughout the school day
- Provide [documentation to parents](#) regarding each crisis incident
- Provide [evidence-based](#) activities to increase capabilities to their full potential
- Provide an opportunity to [debrief with the student](#) after each crisis
- Provide opportunities for committee representation
- Provide opportunities for families to complete satisfaction surveys

- Provide [transition](#) opportunities within the school setting
- 6. Use of Debriefing Techniques**
 - Implement after EACH crisis behavior
 - The purpose is to prevent future ESIs and prevent trauma to staff and students
 - Includes:
 - Immediate post-event discussion with the student and staff:
 - Ensure all parties are safe and calm
 - Get facts from all parties involved
 - Determine classroom re-entry procedures
 - Complete [Debriefing Form](#)
 - Communication of ESI to the executive team member(s) by the on-site supervisor
 - Purpose of Communication:
 - Informs of working conditions
 - Informs of needed support
 - Informs of needed performance development
 - [Analysis of Debriefing Form](#) with the crisis team
 - Completed within 1-2 days after the ESI
 - Includes student or student designee, parent or guardian, staff involved, on-site supervisor, executive team member, medical staff/nurse, and behavioral support staff
 - Use Root Cause Analysis (RCA) tools to determine:
 - What went wrong?
 - What knowledge was unknown or missed?
 - How could we have responded differently?
 - How to avoid the crisis in the future?
 - Communicate the need for particular staff training to the Performance Development Team based on analysis of the Debriefing Form

Adapted from Huckshorn, K.A.; LeBel, J.; Caldwell, B. (Eds.) (2018). Six Core Strategies©: Preventing Violence, Conflict and the Use of Seclusion and Restraint in Inpatient Behavioral Health Settings. An Evidence-based Practice Curriculum Training Manual. Originally developed with the National Association of State Mental Health Program Directors (2002-2009): Alexandria, VA. All rights apply to use of these author edited materials.